KRISTIN GARZA

PRODUCT DESIGNER · ENTERPRISE & FINANCIAL PLATFORMS

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Product Designer with 10+ years of experience across enterprise financial services, project management, and leadership. Specialized in deconstructing complex institutional workflows into highly efficient and simple user experiences. Proven track record of leveraging user insights to drive operational efficiency and deliver data-driven solutions in high stakes environments.

SKILLS

Product Design & Strategy

Problem framing, designing data-dense enterprise workflows, information architecture, and scalable UX patterns.

Execution & Craft

User research, usability testing (UserTesting, Qualtrics), and translating complex insights into validated product decisions.

Research & Insights

High-fidelity prototyping (Figma), interaction design, and ensuring accessibility and usability best practices.

AI-Augmented & Technical Workflows

AI-augmented design (Claude, Lovable), rapid prototyping (Vercel), and front-end development fundamentals (HTML/CSS).

Systems Thinking

Architecting solutions across fragmented enterprise ecosystems using Service Blueprinting to map end-to-end user journeys against technical constraints.

Regulatory & Compliance UX:

Designing within rigid financial regulatory constraints (FINRA/SEC); managing secure Identity & Access Management (IAM) and authentication workflows.

Collaboration & Product Delivery

Agile delivery (JIRA, Confluence), cross-functional leadership, and data-informed decision-making via Adobe Analytics.

EXPERIENCE

2022 – 2025

Lead UX Designer, Trading | Fidelity Investments

Platform Ecosystem Strategy: Unified 15+ trading applications under a standardized design system, replacing legacy fragmentation with reusable atomic components. Reduced development overhead and accelerated speed-to-market while ensuring a cohesive, enterprise-wide platform experience.

Strategic Leadership & Product Vision: Partnered with PM and Engineering leadership to align disparate trading squads under a unified roadmap; led the strategic prioritization of high-impact design efforts within technical and regulatory constraints to ensure the most valuable product enhancements were delivered first.

Performance Optimization: Streamlined data-dense trading interfaces to reduce costly trade errors and service inquiries that burdened product, sales, and service teams. Transformed legacy bottlenecks into high-velocity workflows that increased user satisfaction and long-term platform loyalty.

AI-Driven Delivery: Leveraged AI-augmented workflows to discover, build, and test more quickly for earlier stakeholder alignment and collaboration on complex, data-dense, and technical features.

2021 – 2022

UX Designer, Core Platform Utilities | Fidelity Investments

User Research: Conducted targeted user research and usability testing to demystify opaque institutional workflows, translating qualitative findings into actionable design recommendations for platform-wide utilities including search, workflow management, security & authentication, and help systems.

Cross-functional Leadership: Facilitated design thinking workshops that brought together developers, product owners, and user groups to foster a collaborative, user-centered product culture.

Strategic Insights: Provided design leadership and visual strategy for internal and client-facing solutions, ensuring a seamless transition from legacy workflows to enhanced digital experiences.

EDUCATION

Human Centered Design Certificate
Cornell University (Online) - 2025

BS Psychology - Cognitive Neuroscience
University of Denver - 2014
Magna Cum Laude

EXPERIENCE

2021

UX Design Immersive | General Assembly

Intensive Career Transition: Completed an 1000+ hour immersive program with a dedicated outcomes focus, mastering the end-to-end product lifecycle from discovery to delivery.

Sharper Sense (Client Consultancy): Led a high-impact design sprint to define product strategy and core feature sets for a biotech company, delivering a full handoff of a high-fidelity prototyped site and strategic content that facilitated successful seed funding and initial launch.

Epic Funds(Client Consultancy): Led a comprehensive product discovery and redesign process for a private equity fund. Provided strategic consultation to determine optimal product-market fit between a promotional site and a functional technology platform, resulting in increased brand clarity and consumer engagement.

Stakeholder Management: Developed and presented high-fidelity prototypes and research synthesis to local business partners, ensuring design solutions aligned with technical constraints and business goals.

2014 - 2021

Trading, Leadership, Operations & Project Management

Fidelity Investments

Strategic Career Progression: Progressed through foundational roles from retail trading and brokerage operations to Agile project management, team leadership, and new employee onboarding.

Service Design & Onboarding: Directed site-wide onboarding for 150+ new hires, redesigning the training 'user journey' to drastically reduce speed-to-proficiency and improve employee engagement.

Operational Strategy & Cost Savings: Delivered $1.2M in annual cost savings by re-engineering a 500-person operations workflow—utilizing systems thinking to define new performance metrics and career progressions.

Early UX Leadership: Awarded 1st place in Fidelity's company wide Process Improvement Competition for a user-centered redesign of the account re-registration process; advised mobile and web trading squads on design decisions via the Young Savvy Advisory Board; attended and provided internal SME guidance at hackathon conference to help modernize an internal operations application.